MIL-F-2071D
30 September 1976
SUPERSEDING
MIL-F-2071C
30 March 1966

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FLAG, NATIONAL, UNITED STATES OF AMERICA, GRAVE DECORATING, PRINT CLOTH

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope.- This specification covers one type and size of US National Flag used for grave decorating.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents.- The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS
FEDERAL
V-T-276 - Thread, Cotton
MM-L-763 - Lumber, Hardwood
UU-P-268 - Paper, Kraft, Wrapping
CCC-C-446 - Cloth, Muslin, Cotton
MMM-A-125 - Adhesive, Casein-Type, Water and Mold Resistant
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-T-45 - Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, For Sealing and Securing

STANDARDS
FEDERAL
FED-STD-751 - Stitch, Seam and Stitching
FED-STD-191 - Textile, Test Methods
MILITARY
MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

DRAWINGS
THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY
5-1-17 - Flag, National; United States of America; 50 Star Union Jack

BENEFICIAL COMMENTS (RECOMMENDATIONS, ADDITIONS, DELETIONS) AND ANY PERTINENT DATA WHICH MAY BE USED IN IMPROVING THIS DOCUMENT SHOULD BE ADDRESSED TO: DIRECTOR, THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY, US ARMY, CAMERON STATION, ALEXANDRIA, VA 22314, BY USING THE SELF-ADDRESSED STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL (DD FORM 1426) APPEARING AT THE END OF THIS DOCUMENT OR BY LETTER.

/FSC 8345/

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T14:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Copies of specifications, standards and drawings required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

(Figure 1 is a miniature reproduction of Drawing No. 5-1-17, and is attached for information purposes only.)

2.2 Other publications.- The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

THE COLOR ASSOCIATION OF THE UNITED STATES, INC.
Standard Color Card of America, 9th Edition

(Application for copies of the color card should be addressed to The Color Association of the United States, Inc., 200 Madison Avenue, New York, NY 10016.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard sample.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the contracting officer shall furnish a standard sample for matching color shades and colorfastness to water and weathering only.

3.2 First article.- When specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a sample of the finished flag shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for inspection and tests as specified in 4.2. The approval of the first article authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the manufacturer of responsiblity for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The first article shall be manufactured in the same manner and by the same facilities to be used for the production items.

3.3 Materials.- Materials shall conform to the referenced specifications and the requirements specified herein.

3.3.1 Cloth, cotton.- The base cloth shall conform to the type VI, class 2 of CCC-C-446, with the following exceptions:

a. Colorfastness to light, laundering, bleaching, perspiration, and crocking shall not apply.
b. The non-fibrous material in the cloth shall not exceed 6.2 percent.
c. The shrinkage shall not exceed 6.0 percent in the warp direction and 8.2 percent in the filling direction.
d. The filling picks per inch shall be 56 plus or minus 5.

3.3.1.1 Printing.- The flag design (see 3.4), shall be printed so that the warp threads of the muslin shall be in the fly (longitudinal) direction of the flag. All sides of the canton or union shall be parallel or perpendicular to the sides of the flag. The various areas of design shall be properly registered with respect to each other and present defined sharp demarcations with a minimum of feathering. All areas of the design shall have solid coverage. The star group shall be equidistant from each side of the canton (after the hems have been formed).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T14:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.1.2 Color.- The colors of the flag shall conform to the Standard Color Card of America (see 2.2). The colors shall be as follows:

Old Glory Blue - Cable No. 70075
Old Glory Red - Cable No. 70180
White - Cable No. 70001

3.3.1.3 Colorfastness.- The finished flag shall show colorfastness to weathering equal to or better than the standard sample. When a standard sample is not available, the finished flag shall show good colorfastness to weathering.

3.3.2 Thread.- The thread for stitching the hems shall be white, soft finish, cotton, machine thread and shall be not finer than ticket No. 50, 3 ply, type IA2 of V-T-276.

3.3.3 Wood.- The wood for the staff shall be a clear, straight grained well seasoned hardwood conforming to MM-L-736. Any of the following wood species may be used:

Ash (White)	Locust (Black)
Beech	Maple, hard (Sugar or Black)
Birch (Sweet or Yellow)	Oak (Red or White)
Elm (Rock)	Pecan

3.3.4 Staples.- Staples shall be bright, blued or zinc-coated steel wire not less than .021 inch in diameter. The staples shall be of the size and leg length to securely attach the flag to the flagstaff.

3.4 Design.- The design of the flag shall be in accordance with Drawing No. 5-1-17. The finished flag shall be 7 inches, plus 1/2 inch, minus 0 inch, in the hoist dimension and 11 inches, plus 1/2 inch, minus 0 inch, in the fly direction. All measurements are to be made on the face side of the flag, which is the side nearest the observer when the flag is held with the canton or union in the upper left hand corner. The interior dimensions of the flag shall be as shown on Drawing No. 5-1-17. Tolerances for dimensions exceeding 1 inch shall be plus or minus 1/8 inch and those less than 1 inch shall be plus or minus 1/16 inch for the interior dimensions.

3.5 Construction.-

3.5.1 Hems.- Hemming shall be accomplished using thread specified in 3.3.2, and stitch type 301, seam type EFb-1 of FED-STD-751, with not less than 8 stitches per inch or more than 10 stitches per inch. Flag hems shall be not less than 1/8 inch and may be up to 3/8 inch wide. Selvage edges need not be hemmed provided the stripe meets the dimensional requirements. All sides of the flag shall be perpendicular or parallel to each other.

3.5.2 Spearheads.- Spearheads shall be fabricated from wood specified in 3.3.3. The spearheads shall be tapered, turned or sanded smooth and gilded with a hole drilled in the base to a minimum depth of 1/2 inch to accept the staff. The finished spearheads shall be 2-1/4 inches, plus 1/4 inch, minus 0 inch, in length.

3.5.3 Staff.- The staff for the flag shall be fabricated from wood specified in 3.3.3. Dowels not less than 3/8 inch in diameter shall be turned or sanded smooth. One end of the staff shall be tapered to a diameter of 1/8 inch, plus or minus 1/32 inch. The length of the taper shall be 1-1/2 inches, plus or minus 1/4 inch. The staffs shall be natural color of the wood without a protective coating.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T14:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.4 Assembly.- The spearhead shall be securely attached to the blunt or top end of the staff with a casein type (water resistant) adhesive conforming to type I of MMM-A-125. The assembled length of the spearhead and staff shall measure 24-3/4 inches, plus 1/2 inch, minus 0 inch, in length. The flag shall be attached to the top of the staff by three staples specified in 3.3.4. The staples shall pierce the heading hem at the top, center and bottom. Staples through one thickness of material shall not be acceptable.

3.6 Workmanship.- The finished assembled flags shall be clean well-made and shall meet the acceptable quality levels established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Inspection responsibility.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to the prescribed requirements.

4.2 First article inspection.- Inspection and testing of the first article shall be made on a completely finished flag for all provisions of this specification applicable to the end item examination and tests.

4.3 Inspection for acceptance.- Inspection for acceptance shall be in accordance with the provisions of MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 Inspection of components.-

4.3.1.1 Testing of components.- In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and standards, inspection shall be performed on components and materials listed in table I for the test characteristics shown. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the requirements applicable to the individual unit and the results shall be reported as pass or fail.

TABLE I Component testing.-

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Rqm't para	Test method	#determ per s/u	Sample unit
Print cloth (1 yd)	Colorfastness	3.3.1.3	No. 5671 2/	1	12 inch square
Wood (Staff and spearheads) 1/	Species and seasoning	3.3.3	Std comm'l	1	6 inch piece of dowel
Staples 1/	Finish	3.3.4	Std comm'l	1	1 staple

1/ Components and materials may be accepted on basis of a contractor's certification of compliance for requirements specified herein.
2/ This test is from FED-STD-191.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T14:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.2 Examination of the end item.-

4.3.2.1 Visual examination of end item.- Defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.3.2.1.1 and 4.3.2.1.2. The lots shall be in accordance with 4.3 2.1.3. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one completely finished flag.

4.3.2.1.1 Examination for defects in design, material, construction, and workmanship.- Examination shall be made while viewing the flag at a distance of 16 to 22 inches under illumination equal to normal daylight. Defects designated by an asterisk (*) shall be classified major when seriously affecting serviceability or appearance and minor when affecting appearance or serviceability but not seriously.

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	(*)	Minor
Flag				
Material	Not type specified.	x	-	-
	Hole or weakening defect such as slub, float, or smash which may be expected to develop into a hole.	x	-	-
	Cut, mend, or tear affecting appearance.	x	-	-
	Soiled or stained.	-	*	-
Design	Any characteristic of design obscured, irregular, not in register or overlapping.	x	-	-
	Incorrect or altered arrangement or detail.	x	-	-
Seams and stitch type	Stitch margin not as specified.	-	*	-
	Stitch type or seam type not as specified.	x	-	-
	Less than 8 stitches per inch.	x	-	-
	More than 10 stitches per inch.	-	-	x
Hemming (when applicable)	Hems less than 1/8 inch wide.	x	-	-
	Hems more than 3/8 inch wide.	x	-	-
	Hems badly twisted affecting appearance.	-	*	-
	Thread ends not trimmed.	-	-	x
	Open seam 1/4 inch or more.	x	-	-
	Open seam less than 1/4 inch.	-	-	x
	Broken stitches causing an unstitched length of less than 1/2 inch.	-	-	x
	Broken stitches causing an unstitched length of more than 1/2 inch.	x	-	-
	Raw edge more than 1/2 inch.	x	-	-
	Color of thread not white.	-	-	x
Construction	Warp threads not in the fly or longitudinal direction of the flag.	x	-	-
	All sides of flag canton or union not parallel or perpendicular to each other (out of square) affecting appearance.	-	*	-
	Star group not centered in canton.	x	-	-
Spearhead and staff	Spearhead missing.	x	-	-
	Wood of staff not straignt grained.	-	*	-
	Wood of staff not natural color.	-	-	x

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T14:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	(*)	Minor
	Staff or spearhead not smoothly finished.	-	*	-
	Staff bowed more than 1/2 inch.	x	-	-
	Staff bowed more than 1/4 inch, but less than 1/2 inch	-	-	x
	Spearhead not gilded.	x	-	-
	Spearhead has been gilded in spots affecting appearance.	-	*	-
	Taper of staff not as specified.	-	*	-
Assembly	Spearhead not securely glued to staff.	x	-	-
	Less than three staples fastening flag to staff. . .	x	-	-
	Staples improperly placed or improperly applied. . .	-	*	-
	Not stapled through heading or stapled through only one thickness of print cloth.	x	-	-

4.3.2.1.2 Examination of flag for defects in dimensions.- Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified a defect.

4.3.2.1.3 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's).- The inspection levels and the AQL's expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection level	AQL Major	AQL Total
For defects applicable to 4.3.2.1.1	II	2.5	6.5
For defects applicable to 4.3.2.1.2	S-2	(one class)	10.0

4.3.3 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.- An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packed, selected just prior to the closing operation. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing, any component damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of case liners, container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling.
	Bulging or distortion of containers.
Weight	Net weight exceeds requirements.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.- Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T14:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.1 Level A.- Ten (10) completely assembled flags shall be tightly bundled together. The cloth section of bundled flags shall be wrapped with 30 pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to grade B of UU-P-268. Each wrapped package shall be securely sealed with a 2 inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III of PPP-T-45.

5.1.2 Level C.- Assembled flags shall be preserved and packaged in a manner which will afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration, and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier's commercial practice will be acceptable when it fulfills the above requirements.

5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.- Flags packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to class weather-resistant, V3c or V3s, style RSC of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification. The contents in each shipping container shall not exceed the size and weight limitations of the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B.- Flags packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting, shipping container conforming to type CF, weather-resistant of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with appendix of the container specification. Weight of contents of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

5.2.3 Level C.- Flags packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- The flag is intended for use in decorating the graves of deceased Military personnel in National Cemeteries.

6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) When a standard sample is not furnished (see 3.1).
(c) When first article is required (see 3.2).
(d) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

Custodians:
Army - IH
Navy - SH
Review Activities:
Navy - SA
DSA - DP
User Activities:
Navy - CG

Preparing Activity:

The Institute of Heraldry,
United States Army

Project No. 8345-0110

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T14:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

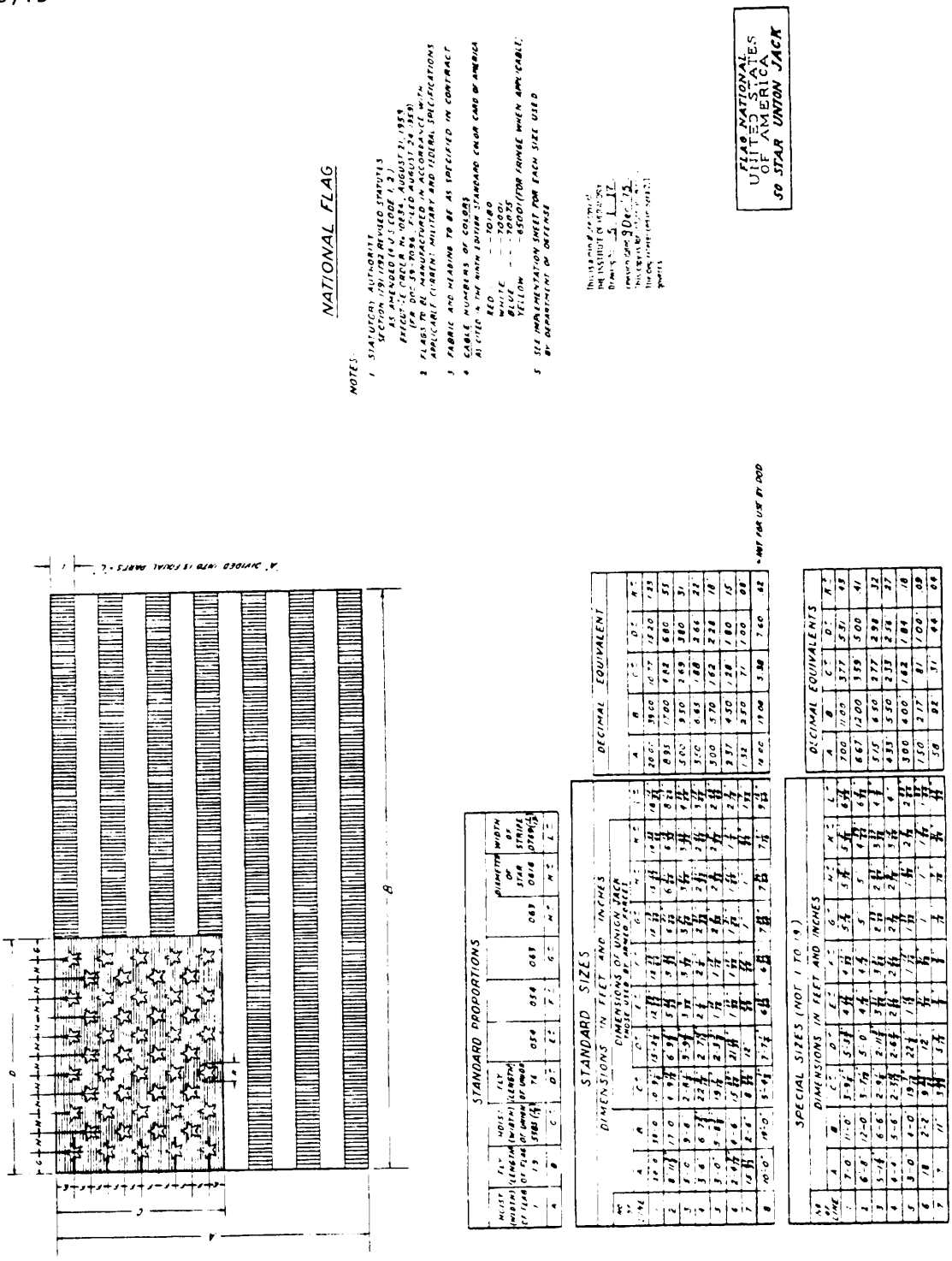


FIGURE 1

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T14:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/ vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-F-2071 Flag, National, United States of America, Grave Decorating

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 72 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 JAN 66 WHICH MAY BE USED

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T14:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FOLD

THE [illegible] ARMY
[illegible]
[illegible]

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
DOD – 314



THE INSTITUTE OF [illegible], US ARMY
Cameron Station, 5010 Duke Street
Alexandria, Virginia 22314

FOLD

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T14:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.